

Due on monday, April 22nd.

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1.  $A = (A^0, A^1, A^2, A^3)$  and  $B = (B^0, B^1, B^2, B^3)$  are 4-vectors. Under a Lorentz transformation from frame  $\Sigma$  to  $\tilde{\Sigma}$ , the components of  $A$  transform as

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{A}^0 &= \gamma_v \left( A^0 - \frac{v}{c} A^1 \right) , & \tilde{A}^1 &= \gamma_v \left( A^1 - \frac{v}{c} A^0 \right) , \\ \tilde{A}^2 &= A^2 \cos \theta + A^3 \sin \theta , & \tilde{A}^3 &= -A^2 \sin \theta + A^3 \cos \theta .\end{aligned}$$

- (a) **[SELF]** Write the transformations as a matrix equation.  
 (b) **[2 pts]** Write down the transformations for the components of  $B$ .  
 (c) **[6 pts]** Show that the inner product, defined as

$$A \star B = A^0 B^0 - A^1 B^1 - A^2 B^2 - A^3 B^3 ,$$

is invariant under this transformation.

- (d) **[2 pts]** The Lorentz transformation described here consists of a boost and a rotation. Describe in words how frame  $\tilde{\Sigma}$  is moving and oriented with respect to frame  $\Sigma$ .

2. In the lab frame, particle  $B$  moves to the right with speed  $u$ , and particle  $C$  moves to the left with speed  $v$ . In the frame of  $C$ , particle  $B$  is seen to move to the right with speed  $w$ , while particle  $C$  itself is of course at rest.

Of course,  $w$  can be written down in terms of  $u$  and  $v$  using the velocity addition formula, but we will re-derive this formula below using 4-velocities.

I encourage you to use  $c = 1$  units for this problem. (But you can choose.)

- (a) **[3 pts]** In the lab frame, write down the 4-velocities for particle  $B$  and for particle  $C$ .  
 (b) **[3 pts]** In  $C$ 's frame, write down the 4-velocities for  $B$  and  $C$ .  
 (c) **[3 pts]** The inner product of the two 4-velocities should be invariant. Write down an equation equating the inner product in the two frames.  
 (d) **[3 pts]** From the inner product invariance, derive an expression for  $\gamma_w$  in terms of  $\gamma_u$ ,  $\gamma_v$ ,  $u$  and  $v$ . (This equation should be familiar.)  
 (e) **[3 pts]** From the equation relating  $\gamma$ 's, derive an expression for  $w$  in terms of  $u$  and  $v$ . You should have recovered a familiar formula.

3. (Compton scattering.) A photon of wavelength  $\lambda$  collides with a stationary electron. After the collision, the photon scatters at an angle  $\theta$  with respect to the incident direction, and has wavelength  $\lambda'$ . The electron moves with momentum  $p_e$  after the collision, in a direction making angle  $\phi$  with the incident direction of the photon.

- (a) **[3 pts]** Draw the situations before and after, clearly showing everything relevant.
- (b) **[6 pts]** Write down the equation for energy conservation, and two equations for momentum conservation. (Since momentum is a vector, you have one equation for each relevant direction.)
- (c) **[6 pts]** Show that

$$\lambda' = \lambda + \frac{h}{mc}(1 - \cos \theta)$$

Hint: you don't need to introduce velocity. If you need to transform between energy and momentum, use the relation  $E^2 = p^2c^2 + m^2c^4$ .

4. Frames  $\Sigma$  and  $\Sigma'$  are aligned at  $t = t' = 0$ , and  $\Sigma'$  moves with velocity  $v$  relative to  $\Sigma$  in the common  $x, x'$  direction.

- (a) **[2 pts]** Represent (draw) both frames on a common spacetime diagram such that the  $ct$  and  $x$  axes are perpendicular. What angles are made by the  $ct'$  and  $x'$  axes? How are the units for  $x'$  related to the units for  $x$ ?
- (b) **[SELF]** A stick of length  $L$  lies at rest in the  $\Sigma'$  frame, with one end at the origin of the  $\Sigma'$  frame. Draw the world sheet of the stick.
- (c) **[8 pts]** Calculate geometrically the length of the stick measured in the  $\Sigma$  frame. (This will require careful drawings, so please do not submit your first attempt — first work out on rough paper what you want to present, and then produce neat drawings.)